

# The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, JUNE 5, 2025

## A DAY TO CELEBRATE



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Amy Layton taped up signs at a reception and rally Wednesday inside and outside Boston City Hall to mark Pride Month. The rally, organized by City Councilor at Large Henry Santana and more than 45 groups, was also held to support a proposal to codify the Mayor's Office of LGBTQIA2S+ Advancement, established by Mayor Michelle Wu, into law, rather than have it be at the discretion of future mayors. The City Council approved the measure later in the day. **B1.**

## Mass. surtax is now for millionaires+

### Inflation trigger has been raising the bar slightly

By Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

Maybe people should start calling it the "\$1.1 millionaires" tax.

Two-plus years after Massachusetts residents voted to more heavily tax earnings over \$1 million, inflation is steadily raising the bar on who actually needs to pay the extra levy each year.

As written, the constitutional amendment applies a 4 percent surtax on annual income "in excess" of \$1 million. But the measure also included a trigger linking that seven-figure threshold to any changes in the cost of living, meaning the amount someone has to earn to hit the tax is increasing.

State officials have twice adjusted that floor, so tax-filers now have to make over \$1.08 million to begin paying the extra levy, according to state data. Given the inflation-driven increases are not a bug, but a feature, of the surtax, the floor is

destined to continue to rise, adding another dimension to an already unpredictable revenue source.

The changes also have another impact: A surtax widely dubbed the "millionaires tax" at the 2022 ballot box may no longer apply to all Massachusetts millionaires.

"It always felt like a misnomer," Peter Enrich, legal counsel for the campaign that successfully pushed the ballot question, said of the "millionaires tax" label. "The idea was to only impose the tax on what are very high incomes, people who have

ample resources."

While "millionaires tax" has dominated public discussion, surtax proponents and many state officials often use the term "Fair Share" as shorthand for the 4 percentage surtax, which is applied on top of the state's 5 percent income tax. There were about 27,000 Massachusetts taxpayers with annual incomes over \$1 million in 2022, according to Raise Up Massachusetts, which pushed for the surtax.

In less than three years, the levy has generated billions of dollars in revenue for transpor-

**MILLIONAIRES, Page A10**

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**A federal judge denied the government's request to move a Milford teenager, who was arrested by immigration agents, from Burlington to Rhode Island. B1.**

**Market Basket's charter effectively gives Arthur T. Demoulas veto power** that prevents the chain from being sold without his say-so. **D1.**

**The Israeli-backed group distributing food in the Gaza Strip closed its sites,** a day after Palestinians trying to get supplies came under Israeli fire near a center. **A3.**

**Fenway Sports Group is moving forward on a new seven-story office building** on Lansdowne Street near the Green Monster. **D1.**  
**The Red Sox won a game** they needed badly. **C1.**

'I don't think it's illegal. It's not how I would do it.'

MICHAEL RICHARDS, *Massachusetts Association of Public Purchasing Officials*

## Bidding raises more questions on DeMaria

Firm working for campaign landed city PR post as the only bidder

By Stephanie Ebbert

GLOBE STAFF

EVERETT — When he hired his campaign spokesperson as a communications consultant for the city two years ago, Mayor Carlo DeMaria explained it as an act of necessity, not favoritism: George Regan's firm was the only one that had responded to the city's solicitation.

What he didn't explain was how little time the city gave the other would-be bidders.

"Please return your quote . . . by 5 p.m. on Wednesday, March 8, 2023," said the letter. It was dated March 7, for a contract set to begin March 9.

Public relations consultant Dot Joyce — one of three communications professionals city officials said they contacted — said the request from Everett City Hall landed in her inbox the morning it was due. She did not bother to bid.

"A thorough response to a request of this nature would have taken us longer than eight hours to produce," she said.

The city did contact her again a few weeks later, she acknowledged, but she again declined to submit a quote.

In the end, the lone bidder was Regan Communications Group, which was already working for the mayor's campaign and submitted a detailed, 11-page proposal right on time.

The flaws in the procurement process are detailed in public records sought by the Globe amid broader scrutiny of DeMaria's use of taxpayer money.

A state investigator reported in February that DeMaria had improperly received \$180,000 in bonuses, with the largest payments hidden in an unrelated section of the city's budget. DeMaria, a Democrat first elected mayor in 2007, has refused to return the bonuses and insisted he did nothing wrong. He used city-paid lawyers to push back against the report until city councilors balked at paying his legal fees.

Critics within Everett also began sharply questioning

**EVERETT, Page A10**

## Finding an unexpected branch of Tufts family tree

Black student linked to school's white founding family

By Tiana Woodard

GLOBE STAFF

Tufts University had always felt like home for Jaiden Mosley. It was where his love for African American history was nurtured. Where the student body along Walnut Hill welcomed him with open arms. And where he gained lifelong friends.

But in the months leading up to his graduation, Mosley learned his attachment to Tufts ran much deeper. Mosley, a 22-year-old Black man from Maryland, discovered a familial connection

to Peter Tufts Sr., the American colonist whose family later founded the school that bears his name.

"Now that I made that connection, I can call Tufts my own," Mosley said. "It's in my blood."

In a way, the genealogical discovery has reinforced his career goals. He's pursuing a master's in history at the University of Virginia in the fall, with a focus on African American life during the Civil War and Reconstruction. But Mosley's family tree also sheds light on slavery's sweeping legacy across the United States and the complexities of African American identity.

Unlike many African Americans, Mosley grew up knowing some things about his family roots. He has many



ALONSO NICHOLS/TUFTS UNIVERSITY

"Now that I made that connection, I can call Tufts my own. It's in my blood," Jaiden Mosley said.

## Harvard foreign students targeted

Trump imposes 6-month block; also threatens schools' accreditations

By Mike Damiano

GLOBE STAFF

President Trump late Wednesday imposed severe restrictions on international students coming to Harvard University, sidestepping a court order last week that had blocked the administration from revoking the school's ability to enroll students from overseas.

Trump invoked national security powers to impose a six-month block on student visa holders from entering the country to study at Harvard. He also said Secretary of State Marco Rubio would review on a case by case basis the status of current international students to determine whether their visas should be revoked.

"This is yet another illegal retaliatory step taken by the administration in violation of Harvard's First Amendment rights," Harvard spokesperson Sarah Kennedy-O'Reilly said. "Harvard will continue to protect its international students."

The travel ban was just one of two extraordinary steps the Trump administration took Wednesday to ratchet up pressure on elite universities and get them to accede to a series of demands that seek to stamp out what Trump perceives as leftist bias, tolerance of antisemitism, and discrimination against white people and men.

In what could be another ominous develop-

**ACCREDITATION, Page A7**

## President brings back full travel ban for 12 countries

By David Nakamura and Emily Davies

WASHINGTON POST

President Trump issued a proclamation on Wednesday restricting the entry of travelers to the United States from more than a dozen countries, resurrecting and expanding sweeping restrictions from his first term that are expected to draw swift legal challenges.

The proclamation, slated to go into effect Monday, fully restricts and limits the entry of individuals from Afghanistan, Myanmar, Chad, the Republic of the Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Haiti, Iran, Libya, Somalia, Sudan, and Yemen. It also partially restricts the entry of individuals from Burundi, Cuba, Laos, Sierra Leone, Togo, Turkmenistan, and Venezuela.

"We will restore the travel ban, some people call it the Trump travel ban, and keep the radical Islamic terrorists out of our country that was upheld by the Supreme Court," Trump said in a statement.

The Trump administration, in a document circulated Wednesday evening, said the ban is necessary to compel foreign governments to cooperate with their agenda and enforce the country's immigration laws, among other justi-

**TRAVEL BAN, Page A6**

Coming up ACs

**Thursday:** Hot again. High 84-89. Low 69-74.

**Friday:** Cooler, showers. High 75-80. Low 61-66.

Sunrise: 5:08 Sunset: 8:17

**Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.**

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